

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Teens (14–18)

**Q**

**What is the main ingredient in jelly that makes it clear and firm enough to hold its shape?**

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## ANSWER

**Fruit juice**

## FUN FACT

*Jelly is made from clear fruit juice, not mashed fruit.*

Source: SP 50-764 Making jam jellies fruit spreads

# JAMS AND JELLIES



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**Q**

**What role does sugar play in traditional jam and jelly recipes?**

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## ANSWER

**It helps gel formation and acts as a preservative.**

## FUN FACT

*Sugar helps jams set and keeps bacteria from growing.*

Source: SP 50-765 Low sugar fruit spreads

# JAMS AND JELLIES



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## Q

**What is pectin's role in making jams and jellies?**

# JAMS AND JELLIES



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## ANSWER

**It causes the mixture to gel or thicken.**

## FUN FACT

*Fruits like underripe apples and blackberries have more natural pectin.*

Source: SP 50-764 Making jam jellies fruit spreads



**Q**

**Why should you not reduce sugar amounts in traditional pectin jam recipes unless using special pectin?**

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## ANSWER

**Because the gel won't form properly without enough sugar.**

## FUN FACT

*Low sugar pectins need special instructions to ensure safety and texture.*

Source: SP 50-764 Making jam jellies fruit spreads



**Q**

**What is the recommended headspace to leave when filling jars with hot jam before sealing?**

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## ANSWER

**1/4 inch headspace**

## FUN FACT

*Leaving headspace lets jars seal correctly during processing.*

Source: SP 50-777 Jams jellies preserves with no added pectin



## Q

**How do you test if jam or jelly has reached the 'gelling point' without a thermometer?**

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## ANSWER

**Put a small amount on a cold plate in the fridge; if it gels it's ready.**

## FUN FACT

*This simple test helps know when your jam is perfect!*

Source: SP 50-777 Jams jellies preserves with no added pectin

# JAMS AND JELLIES



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## Q

**Why is acid important in jam and jelly making?**

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## ANSWER

**It helps the pectin form a gel and balances flavor.**

## FUN FACT

*Lemon juice is often added to low-acid fruits to help jelly set.*

Source: SP 50-764 Making jam jellies fruit spreads

# JAMS AND JELLIES



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## Q

**What happens if you undercook jam or jelly during preparation?**

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## ANSWER

**It will be runny and not set properly.**

## FUN FACT

*Cook jams quickly to the jelling point for good texture.*

Source: SP 50-604 Remaking soft jellies



**Q**

**When using low-methoxyl pectin for low-sugar jams, what must be included in the recipe?**

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## ANSWER

**Calcium ions and proper acid levels**

## FUN FACT

*Low-methoxyl pectin works differently and can gel with less sugar.*

Source: SP 50-765 Low sugar fruit spreads



**Q**

**How long should you boil jars of low sugar spreads in a boiling water canner for safe storage?**

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## ANSWER

**10 minutes**

## FUN FACT

*Proper processing kills bacteria and seals the jars safely.*

Source: SP 50-765 Low sugar fruit spreads



**Q**

**Why is it important to use firm, slightly underripe fruits when making no-pectin jams and jellies?**

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## ANSWER

**Because underripe fruits contain more natural pectin.**

## FUN FACT

*Natural pectin is highest in cores and seeds of some fruits!*

Source: SP 50-777 Jams jellies preserves with no added pectin



**Q**

**What is the recommended processing time for hot-packed half-pints of jam at 0-1000 feet elevation?**

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## ANSWER

**5 minutes in a boiling water bath**

## FUN FACT

*Processing times increase with altitude to ensure safety.*

Source: SP 50-777 Jams jellies preserves with no added pectin



## Q

**What happens if you reduce the acid level too much when making jam or jelly?**

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## ANSWER

**The gel may weep and fail to set properly.**

## FUN FACT

*Too little acid can stop pectin from forming a strong gel.*

Source: SP 50-764 Making jam jellies fruit spreads

# JAMS AND JELLIES



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**Q**

**Which of the following fruits is considered high in natural pectin suitable for jams and jellies?**

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## ANSWER

### Sour blackberries

## FUN FACT

*Tart fruits and underripe fruits usually have more pectin.*

Source: SP 50-764 Making jam jellies fruit spreads



**Q**

**What effect does overcooking fruit juice have on jelly making?**

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## ANSWER

**It lowers the pectin's ability to gel.**

## FUN FACT

*Don't overcook juice extraction or your jelly may not set!*

Source: SP 50-604 Remaking soft jellies



**Q**

**What should you do immediately after removing jars from the boiling water canner?**

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## ANSWER

**Wait 5 minutes before removing jars from the canner.**

## FUN FACT

*Waiting helps prevent jar breakage and ensures vacuum seal.*

Source: SP 50-777 Jams jellies preserves with no added pectin



## Q

**How can honey be used when making jams with commercial pectin?**

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## ANSWER

**It can replace up to 1 cup of sugar but changes texture slightly.**

## FUN FACT

*Honey adds flavor but can make spreads a bit softer.*

Source: SP 50-764 Making jam jellies fruit spreads

# JAMS AND JELLIES



Teens (14–18)

**Q**

**Why should you not double traditional jam recipes without special instructions?**

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## ANSWER

**Because cooking and gelling times won't be accurate.**

## FUN FACT

*Some commercial pectin products have "Flex Batch" instructions to allow doubling safely.*

Source: SP 50-808 Pectin facts



**Q**

**What is a safe practice when making freezer jams compared to cooked jams?**

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## ANSWER

**Use fully ripe fruit and prepare according to tested recipes without heating.**

## FUN FACT

*Freezer jams use uncooked pectin to gel without boiling.*

Source: SP 50-763 Uncooked freezer jams



**Q**

**Why is it important to wipe jar rims before putting on lids when canning jam?**

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## ANSWER

**To ensure a clean seal and prevent contamination.**

## FUN FACT

*Dirt or jam on rims can cause lids to leak or not seal properly.*

Source: SP 50-777 Jams jellies preserves with no added pectin